

INTRODUCTION TO MULTIMEDIA

COURSE SYLLABUS // JOSHUA MUSTER // ROOM #92



Course Description & Goal

This year-long elective introduces students to the world of graphic design and visual communication.

Students will learn how to communicate visually using free, industry-relevant tools like Adobe Express.

We will explore the history of design—from illuminated manuscripts and typesetting to modern branding—while building practical skills through hands-on projects.

The course emphasizes creativity, design principles, branding, communication, and portfolio development to create meaningful learning experiences that encourage 21st century digital skills.

Curriculum Overview

Foundations of Design

- Introduction to Graphic Design & Visual Culture
- Design History: Illuminated Manuscripts, Calligraphy, and Typesetting
- Elements & Principles of Design
- Color Theory & Symbolism
- Typography Basics & Font Pairing
- **Projects:** Illuminated Letter Poster, Color Wheel Infographic, Name Poster, Visual Metaphor Collage

Branding & Identity

- Logo Design Process (sketch to digital)
- Personal Brand Kit Development
- Event Poster Design
- Peer Critiques & Audience Awareness
- **Projects:** Logo Design, Personal Brand Kit, School Event Flyer

Real-World Communication

- Ad Design & Target Audience Analysis
- Ethics in Visual Communication
- PSA Poster Project
- Flyer Redesign Challenge
- **Projects:** Ad Campaign, PSA Poster, Flyer Redesign

Final Projects & Portfolio

- Organizing and Curating Portfolio Work
- Giving and Receiving Design Feedback
- Final Project Proposal & Execution
- Class Gallery Walk / Showcase
- **Projects:** Final Project (student choice), Digital Design Portfolio

Student Expectations

Bring your creativity and a positive attitude! **Be ready to try, reflect, revise, and grow.**

Students should :

- Bring a functional and fully charged laptop to class every day. We will work outside frequently, weather-permitting.
- Participate in all class activities;
- Treat others with respect and kindness;
- Stay at their workstations and not use or touch another student's computer or lab equipment;
- Be open to exchange healthy, constructive criticism with their peers;
- Follow the rest of Fresno Unified's expectations and guidelines, including but not limited to Dress Code and Student Behavior.

Other policies to note :

- No eating in the computer labs.
- No bathroom passes the first or last 10 minutes of class.
- No video games during class.
- Cell phones and/or Bluetooth devices are not allowed to be used at any time during the class period.
- No checking grades in Atlas once class starts.
- No applying makeup during class.

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Assessment & Grading

Grading will be based on a variety of class activities, including digital journal entries, review questions, and computer coding projects. All assignments will be evaluated using rubrics provided by Code.org, ensuring consistency and clarity in grading.

Students are given ample time in class to complete their work. Any assignment not finished during class is due by midnight that same day without penalty.

If a student has an **excused absence** (such as a medical appointment or school activity), *the assignment must be submitted on the day they return*.

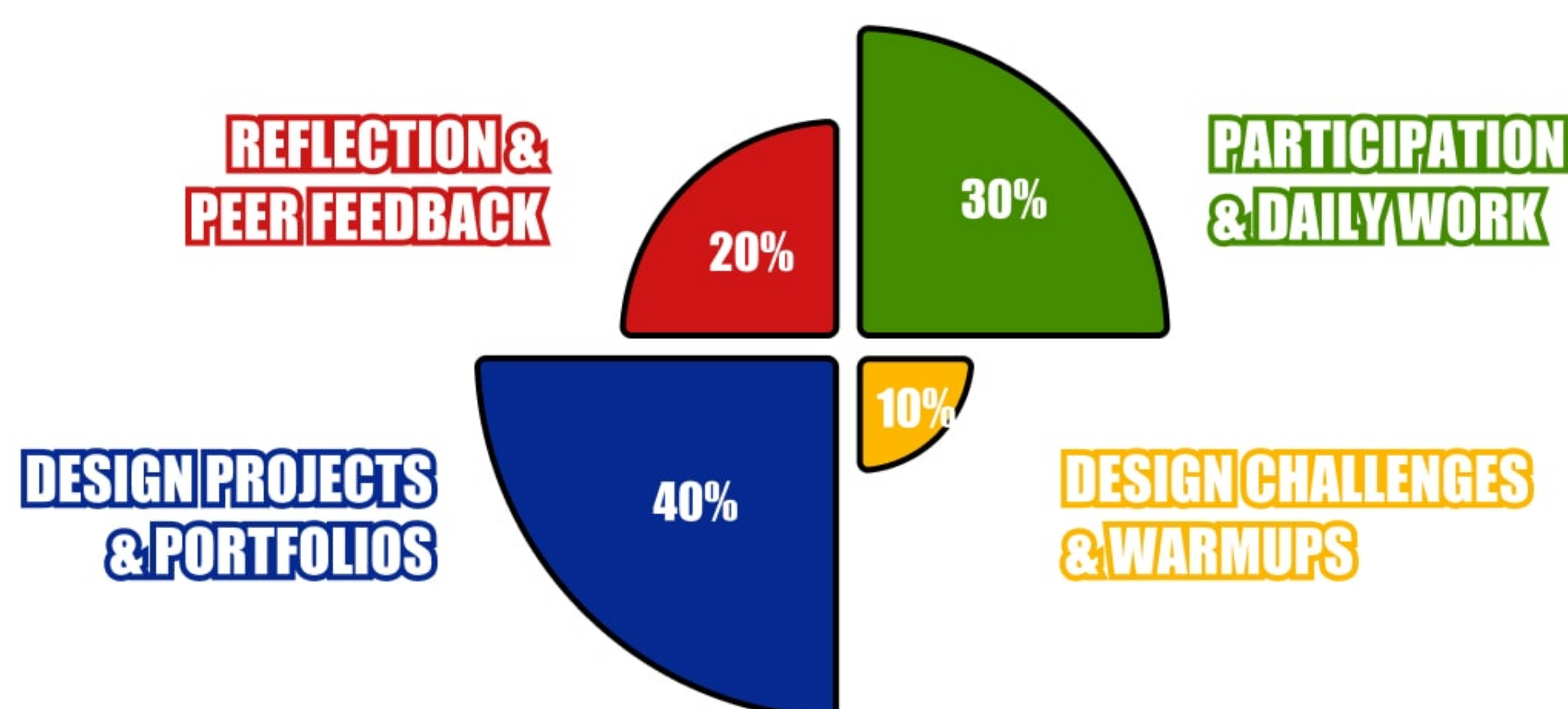
For **unexcused late work**, the maximum score that can be earned is 60%. Late submissions also forfeit the opportunity to revise or resubmit for a higher grade.

Assignments will not be accepted more than one week after the original due date.

If a student is absent and does not understand the assignment on their own, it is their responsibility to meet with me or reach out to me to receive direct instruction and clarification.

Grading Breakdown

- Design Projects & Portfolios – 40%
- Participation & Daily Work – 30%
- Reflections & Peer Feedback – 20%
- Design Challenges & Warm-Ups – 10%



Contacting Mr. Muster

There are several ways you can contact me.

I will be in Room #92 and available to talk *during lunch* on Tuesdays and Thursdays.

I can also be reached at my email and phone number, listed at the bottom of the page.

- **Students** – I prefer contact via Teams, as I monitor it closely since my computer and phone notify me about new messages.
- **Parents** – Email or ParentSquare are preferred. I don't use Atlas for messaging as it does *not* notify me about new messages.

End-of-Year Goal

By the end of the course, each student will have a polished digital portfolio showcasing their work and progress as a designer, ready to share with friends, family, and future programs.

Important Notice

The instructor retains the right to modify the syllabus at any point during the academic year to better meet the needs of the class or to reflect changes in the curriculum. Any amendments will be communicated to both parents and students in a timely manner. A revised version of the syllabus will be distributed physically and digitally to ensure everyone is informed of the updates. Your understanding and cooperation are greatly appreciated as we strive to provide the best educational experience for our students.

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STUDENT AND PARENT SYLLABUS AGREEMENT

Acknowledgment

By initialing and signing on this page, we confirm that we have read and understand the Curriculum Overview, Contacting Mr. Muster, Assessment & Grading, Student Expectations, and Important Notice that are listed in this Introduction To Multimedia syllabus.

Student's
Initials

Parent's
Initials

☐☐

Cell phones and/or Bluetooth devices are not allowed to be used at any time during the class period. Use of one in class will result in the device being confiscated and taken to the office.

☐☐

Students will stay at their workstations and not use or touch another student's computer or lab equipment for any reason.

☐☐

Bathroom passes will not be granted the first 10 minutes or the last 10 minutes of class. Excessive use of bathroom passes will warrant a call to student's parents for a health and wellbeing check.

☐☐

There will be NO extra credit opportunities, instead students have one week to resubmit any assignment one time to improve upon their learning.

☐☐

Students will have one week to submit late work. No credit can be earned on a late assignment if it is received after the one-week extension.

☐☐

When a student submits an assignment late, that student has forfeited the opportunity to recover the assignment and they cannot resubmit the assignment for a better grade.

☐☐

Students who have an excused absence on the day an assignment is due must submit the assignment the day they return. This is particularly important for student athletes.

☐☐

If you are absent and do not understand the assignment on your own, it is your responsibility to meet with me or reach out to me to receive direct instruction and clarification *before* the deadline.

☐☐

There will be no eating in the computer lab. Closed container drinks (such as water bottles with lids) will be acceptable, as long as they are kept next to their seat or under their desk.

Student Name _____

Parent/Guardian Name _____

Signature _____

Signature _____

Today's Date _____

Today's Date _____